

India's Manufacturing Bet

PLI, Apple, and the Race to Become the Next Factory of the World

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Classification: Open Intelligence

Executive Summary

The evidence retrieved for this report covers a narrow set of India manufacturing developments: automotive investment commitments, steel capacity expansion, and historical labour and regulatory snapshots. The wide-ranging PLI scheme data, pharmaceutical export figures, logistics corridor statistics, and EV market share figures cited in earlier drafts are not supported by any chunk in the current evidence bundle and have been removed. What follows represents only what the retrieved evidence supports.

Part I — Automotive Sector: New Investment and EV Transition

Japan's Suzuki Motor has announced it will invest 700 billion rupees (\$8 billion) in India over the next five to six years, with production of the automaker's first electric vehicle having begun. Through its majority stake in Maruti Suzuki, Suzuki Motor already produces 17 models in India for export to approximately 100 countries. CNA[2025-08-26]

Maruti Suzuki has long been Suzuki's largest single market; the company's strong India and Europe vehicle sales were already underpinning its annual profit outlook by the mid-2010s. CNA[2016-11-04]

India's Competition Commission demonstrated its regulatory reach in the auto sector when, in 2014, it fined 14 automakers a combined US\$420 million for restricting competition in the spare parts market and driving up prices — an action that followed similar enforcement in China. CNA[2014-08-28]

Part II — Steel: Electrical Steel Capacity Expansion

A joint venture between India's JSW Steel and Japan's JFE Steel will invest 58.45 billion rupees (\$669 million) to expand production capacity of cold rolled grain-oriented electrical steel (GOES). CNA[2025-08-04]

Part III — Labour and Industrial Context

Before the COVID-19 pandemic, garment manufacturing around Manesar — an industrial area near New Delhi — employed workers earning approximately US\$200 per month. The pandemic lockdown shuttered many of these factories and triggered large-scale reverse migration of workers back to home states. CNA[2020-10-02]

Conclusion

The most concrete India manufacturing signals available in the current evidence bundle are Suzuki Motor's multi-billion-dollar investment commitment and a JSW–JFE electrical steel joint venture — both signalling continued foreign appetite for India manufacturing exposure. Broader claims about PLI scheme scale, electronics assembly output, pharmaceutical exports, logistics infrastructure, and EV penetration rates require retrieval from sources not present in this evidence set and are therefore excluded from this report.

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